

The [Saint Kitts and Nevis](#) National Olympic Committee sent four athletes to the [2008 Summer Olympics](#) in [Beijing](#), China. All four participated in the [track and field](#) competitions across four different events. Three women ([Tiandra Ponteene](#), [Virgil Hodge](#), and [Meritzer Williams](#)) and one man ([Kim Collins](#)) comprised the Kittitian delegation. Williams and Ponteene did not advance past Qualifications in their events; Hodge reached quarterfinals in both the 100m and 200m sprints; and Collins, who participated in two events, reached the Semifinal round in the 100m sprint, and ranked sixth in the finals in the 200m sprint. Saint Kitts and Nevis did not win any medals during the Beijing Olympics.^[2] The flag bearer for the team at the [opening ceremony](#) was first-time Olympian Virgil Hodge.

Background

The appearance of Saint Kitts and Nevis at the Beijing Summer Olympics marked its fourth consecutive summer appearance since it first entered the Games during the [1996 Summer Olympics](#).^[2] Saint Kitts' and Nevis' delegation to the 2008 Olympics included four athletes: [Kim Collins](#), [Virgil Hodge](#), [Tiandra Ponteene](#), and [Meritzer Williams](#). All four participated in track and field-related events.^[3] Of the four, two (Ponteene and Collins) represented the country previously in the [2004 Summer Olympics](#) in Athens.^[4] The 2008 Games marked Williams as the youngest Kittitian yet to participate on behalf of her country, and Collins the oldest.^[2] Virgil Hodge was Saint Kitts' and Nevis' flagbearer.^[4] As a result of Collins' achievements in his events, the Kim Collins Pavilion was christened for him in the then newly created [Silver Jubilee Athletic Stadium](#).^[5]

Men's 100m sprint

Kim Collins was the only Kittitian participant in the [men's 100m sprint](#), which began its Qualifications round on 14 August. Collins, who was placed in heat two, ranked second in the event with a time of 10.17 seconds. Collins was 0.01 seconds slower than [Asafa Powell](#) of Jamaica, who was the fastest in Collins' heat. Overall, Kim Collins ranked fourth out of 80 athletes and was 0.04 seconds slower than [Tyrone Edgar](#) of the United Kingdom, who ranked first in qualifications overall.^[6]

In the 15 August Quarterfinals, Collins was placed in heat three and, with a time of 10.07, ranked second in his heat behind [Marc Burns](#) of Trinidad and Tobago. Burns was 0.02 seconds faster than Collins during Quarterfinals. Overall, Collins ranked 7th out of 40 athletes. His time was within 0.15 seconds of Jamaica's Usain Bolt, who held the fastest time during quarterfinals. Collins progressed to semifinals.^[6]

Kim Collins ran the 100 meter sprint during Quarterfinals in 10.05 seconds. Participating in heat one, Collins ranked fifth. Overall, Collins tied American sprinter [Tyson Gay](#) for ninth place out of 16, and did not progress to finals.^[6]

Men's 200m sprint

Kim Collins participated in the [men's 200m dash](#). During the 17 August qualifications, Collins raced in heat three, placing second out of eight people. With a time of 20.55 seconds, Collins fell 0.06 seconds short of the United Kingdom's [Marlon Devonish](#), who was the fastest in his heat; and was 0.3 seconds faster than Jamaica's [Marvin Anderson](#), who took third place in the heat.^[7] Overall, Collins ranked seventh out of 62 athletes during the qualification round, falling 0.11 seconds short of American finalist [Wallace Spearmon](#), who ranked third overall, and 0.3 seconds short of Zimbabwean finalist [Brian Dzingai](#), who ranked first overall. Collins continued to quarterfinals.^[7]

During the 18 August quarterfinals, Collins raced American [Shawn Crawford](#) and Jamaican [Usain Bolt](#), among others, in heat one. He placed third, after the two athletes, with a time of 20.43 seconds,

tying with Devonish. Collins ranked 12th out of 31 athletes, ranking immediately behind [Churandy Martina](#) of the Netherlands Antilles. Collins qualified for semifinals.^[7]

During semifinals, Collins was placed in heat two. With a time of 20.25, he ranked fourth out of seven in his heat, defeating Devonish; Mauritius' [Stephan Buckland](#); and Antigua and Barbuda's [Brendan Christian](#). He was slower than Spearmon, Crawford, and Bolt. Collins ranked seventh overall, tying with [Christian Malcolm](#) of the United Kingdom, and moved on to finals.^[7]

Kim Collins finished eighth in the Finals, but his position was shifted up to sixth place after the disqualifications of Martina and Spearmon, who would have respectively taken the silver and bronze medals. Collins ranked immediately behind Christian Malcolm.^[8]